Himaayah Schools
MADRASAH

FREE GUIDE

وَأَقِيمُوا الصَّلَاةَ وَآتُوا الزَّكَاةَ

"And establish the prayer and give zakāh." (al-Baqarah 2:43)

The Fiqh of Zakāh

Zakāh in the Mālikī school: money, gold, business stock, crops and livestock, who receives it, and how to calculate it, with examples in naira.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Before you begin

Zakāh is the third pillar of Islām. Again and again the Qur'an names it alongside the prayer, and Abū Bakr fought those who refused it, saying: "By Allah, I will fight whoever separates the prayer from zakāh" (al-Bukhārī 1400, Muslim 20). It is not a favour the rich do for the poor; it is the right of the poor in the wealth of the rich, and it purifies the one who pays it:

> خُذْ مِنْ أَمْوَالِهِمْ صَدَقَةً تُطَهِّرُهُمْ وَتُزَكِّيهِم بِهَا
>
> **"Take from their wealth a charity by which you purify them and cause them to grow."**
>
> At-Tawbah 9:103.

This guide explains zakāh according to the school of **Imām Mālik**, following the **Risālah** of Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī and the **Muwaṭṭa**'. It covers money and savings, gold and jewellery, business stock, farm produce and livestock, who may receive zakāh, and how to calculate it, with worked examples in naira.

How to use this guide

Read Parts 1 and 2 first: the conditions and the niṣāb apply to everything that follows.

Then go straight to the kind of wealth you own: money, business, crops or animals.

Use the **worksheet** at the end once a year, on the date your zakāh falls due. Where the scholars differ, the well-known view of the school is given; follow your teacher or your local zakāh committee where they take another accepted view.

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Part 1 Why zakāh matters

The Prophet ﷺ said: “Islām is built on five: testifying that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah, establishing the prayer, giving zakāh, the Ḥajj and fasting Ramaḍān” (al-Bukhārī 8, Muslim 16). Zakāh is a farḍ on everyone it is due from, and denying that it is obligatory takes a person out of Islām.

Its reward	The warning
“Charity does not decrease wealth” (Muslim, 2588).	“Whoever is given wealth by Allah and does not pay its zakāh, his wealth will be made into a bald serpent on the Day of Resurrection, which will coil around his neck” (al-Bukhārī, 1403).
“The example of those who spend their wealth in the way of Allah is like a seed that grows seven ears, in every ear a hundred grains” (al-Baqarah 2:261).	“Those who hoard gold and silver and do not spend it in the way of Allah, give them tidings of a painful punishment” (at-Tawbah 9:34).
It purifies the soul from greed and the wealth from what is not yours (at-Tawbah 9:103).	When a people withhold zakāh, rain is withheld from them (Ibn Mājah, 4019).

Part 2 Who pays, and the niṣāb

The conditions

- **Islām.** Zakāh is an act of worship.
- **Full ownership** of the wealth, with access to it.
- **The niṣāb:** the wealth reaches the minimum amount set by the Sharīʿah.
- **A full lunar year (ḥawl)** passing over the niṣāb, for money, trade goods and livestock. Crops and fruits have no year: their zakāh is due at harvest.
- In the Mālikī school, zakāh is due on the wealth of **children and the insane** too; their guardian pays it from their wealth, as ʿUmar and ʿĀʾishah did for orphans in their care (al-Muwaṭṭaʾ).

The niṣāb of each kind of wealth

Wealth	Niṣāb	Rate
Gold	20 mithqāl (dinars): about **85 grams** of pure gold	2.5% (one fortieth)
Silver	200 dirhams: about **595 grams** of pure silver	2.5%
Cash, savings, business stock	The value of the gold or silver niṣāb (see the note below)	2.5%
Grains, pulses, dates, raisins, olives	5 awsuq = 300 ṣāʿ: about **650 kg** of the dry produce	10% if rain-fed; 5% if irrigated at cost
Sheep and goats	40 animals	See the table in Part 6
Cattle	30 animals	See Part 6
Camels	5 animals	See Part 6
Buried treasure (rikāz)	Any amount	One fifth (20%)

For students

The ḥawl. The year is counted in lunar (Hijrī) months, about 354 days. Choose your zakāh date, for example the first of Ramaḍān, and use it every year. If your wealth falls below the niṣāb during the year, the count starts again when it reaches the niṣāb.

Profit and growth in trade goods and the young of livestock follow their original year: you do not wait a new year for them (al-Muwaṭṭaʾ).

Gold and silver together. In the school, gold and silver (and money) are added together to complete the niṣāb.

Part 3 Money, savings, gold and silver

Paper money and bank balances

The money we use today takes the ruling of gold and silver: cash at home, money in bank accounts, savings, fixed deposits and mobile wallets are all added together. If the total reaches the niṣāb and stays at or above it for a lunar year, pay **2.5%** of the total on your zakāh date.

Gold or silver for the niṣāb of money?

The niṣāb of gold (85 g) is worth many times the niṣāb of silver (595 g) today. Scholars differ on which to use for paper money. Some use **gold**, because money has replaced the dinar; others use **silver**, because it is lower, more cautious and gives more to the poor. Both views are held by scholars today: follow your teacher or your local zakāh committee, and check the current price of gold or silver per gram on your zakāh date.

Jewellery

In the Mālikī school, there is **no zakāh on jewellery a woman owns to wear**, in a normal amount, because it is in use like clothing. ʿĀʾishah looked after her brother's orphaned daughters, who had jewellery, and she did not take zakāh from it (al-Muwaṭṭaʾ). But zakāh **is** due on:

- Jewellery kept as **savings or investment**, or for **trade**.
- Jewellery that is broken and no longer worn, or kept away for years without use, according to many in the school.
- Gold or silver owned by a **man** for wearing (apart from a silver ring), since it is not permitted to him.
- Gold and silver utensils, ornaments and bars.

Debts

Situation	Ruling in the school
You owe debts	Debts you must pay are deducted from your money before checking the niṣāb, if you have no other property (beyond your needs) to cover them. Debts do **not** cancel the zakāh of crops or livestock.
Others owe you money (a loan you gave)	You pay its zakāh **when you receive it**, for one year only, even if it was owed for several years.
Money owed to a continuous trader by his customers	Counted with his stock each year, if he expects to receive it (see Part 4).

Part 4 Business stock (ʿurūḍ at-tijārah)

Goods bought with the intention of selling them for profit are zakatable. The Mālikī school distinguishes two kinds of trader, which makes it fairer and easier than a single rule:

	The continuous trader (mudīr)	The one who waits (muḥtakir)
Who	A shopkeeper or trader who buys and sells all the time: provisions, clothes, phones, building materials.	Someone who buys goods or land and holds them, waiting for a good price.
When	Every year on his zakāh date.	Only when he sells, and only for **one** year, however long he held it.
How	Value all the stock at its **current selling price** (wholesale value), add cash and debts he expects to collect, subtract debts he owes, and pay 2.5%.	Pay 2.5% of the price he receives.

Shop fittings, vehicles, machines and buildings used to run the business are **not** zakatable, only the goods for sale. Land or a house you live in or rent out is not zakatable; the rent you save is added to your money.

Part 5 Crops and fruits

> وَآتُوا حَقَّهُ يَوْمَ حَصَادِهِ
>
> **"And give its due on the day of its harvest."**
>
> Al-Anʿām 6:141.

In the Mālikī school, zakāh is due on crops that are **staple foods that can be stored**: grains such as wheat, barley, maize, millet, sorghum (guinea corn) and rice; pulses such as beans, cowpeas and lentils; and dates, raisins and olives (and oil seeds such as sesame, by some). There is **no zakāh** on vegetables, fresh fruits other than dates and grapes, tubers such as yam and cassava, or cash crops like cocoa and cotton, unless they are traded, when they become business stock.

Point	Detail
Niṣāb	5 awsuq (300 ṣāʿ), about 650 kg of the dried, cleaned produce. Different grains of the same kind (such as wheat and barley, or the pulses) are added together.
Rate	“For what is watered by rain or springs, a tenth; for what is irrigated by labour, half a tenth” (al-Bukhārī, 1483). Partly irrigated: in proportion.
When	At harvest, when the grain is ready; no ḥawl. Costs of farming are not deducted in the school.
Paid as	Part of the produce itself.

Part 6 Livestock

Zakāh is due on camels, cattle and sheep and goats once the niṣāb has been owned for a year. In the Mālikī school this includes animals that are fed by their owner and working animals, not only those that graze freely. Animals kept for trade are business stock instead.

Sheep and goats

Number	Zakāh
1–39	Nothing
40–120	1 sheep or goat
121–200	2
201–399	3
400 and above	1 for every 100

Cattle

Number	Zakāh
1–29	Nothing
30–39	1 tabīʿ (a young bull, two years old in the school)
40–59	1 musinnah (a cow, three years old)
60 and above	For every 30, a tabīʿ; for every 40, a musinnah (e.g. 70 = 1 tabīʿ + 1 musinnah)

Camels

Number	Zakāh
5–9	1 sheep

10–14	2 sheep
15–19	3 sheep
20–24	4 sheep
25–35	1 bint makhāḍ (female camel in its 2nd year)
36–45	1 bint labūn (in its 3rd year)
46–60	1 ḥiqqah (in its 4th year)
61–75	1 jadhaʿah (in its 5th year)
76–90	2 bint labūn
91–120	2 ḥiqqah
Above 120	For every 40, a bint labūn; for every 50, a ḥiqqah

From the letter of Abū Bakr setting out the zakāh of livestock (al-Bukhārī, 1454).

Part 7 Who receives zakāh

إِنَّمَا الصَّدَقَاتُ لِلْفُقَرَاءِ وَالْمَسَاكِينِ وَالْعَامِلِينَ عَلَيْهَا وَالْمُؤَلَّفَةِ قُلُوبُهُمْ وَفِي الرِّقَابِ وَالْغَارِمِينَ وَفِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ وَابْنِ السَّبِيلِ

“Zakāh is only for the poor, the needy, those employed to collect it, those whose hearts are to be reconciled, freeing captives, those in debt, in the cause of Allah, and the stranded traveller.”

At-Tawbah 9:60.

Category	Who they are
Al-fuqarāʾ (the poor)	Those who have something, but not enough for their year’s needs.
Al-masākīn (the needy)	Those who have nothing at all, worse off than the poor in the Mālikī school.
Al-ʿāmilūn ʿalayhā	Those appointed to collect and distribute zakāh, even if rich, paid for their work.
Al-muʾallafah qulūbuhum	New Muslims, or others, whose hearts are to be strengthened in Islām.
Fir-riqāb	Freeing slaves; scholars today apply it to freeing captives.
Al-ghārimūn	Those in debt for a permissible need who cannot pay it.
Fī sabīlillāh	In the school: those striving in jihād and its needs.
Ibn as-sabīl	The traveller cut off from his money, even if rich at home.

In the Mālikī school you may give all your zakāh to **one** category, or one person, if that serves the need best; giving to the neediest first is better. Zakāh may **not** be given to:

- Those you are obliged to support: your parents, your children and your wife. (Other relatives, such as brothers, sisters, aunts and uncles who are poor, are among the best recipients.)
- The rich, and the strong able to earn, apart from the collectors and the other exceptions above.
- Non-Muslims, apart from the muʾallafah.
- The family of the Prophet ﷺ (Banū Hāshim): "Charity is not lawful for the family of Muḥammad" (Muslim, 1072).
- Building masājid or schools, in the well-known view of the school, since they are not among the eight.

Part 8 Paying it

- **Intention** is required when setting the zakāh aside or handing it over. You do not have to tell the poor person it is zakāh.
- **Do not delay** it after it is due. It may be paid a little early, about a month, in the school.
- Give it in the **land where the wealth is**, unless there is greater need elsewhere.
- **Do not** count debts others owe you as zakāh by cancelling them; zakāh must be paid out.
- Keep a simple record each year: your date, what you owned, what you paid and to whom.

Examples Worked examples

Example prices only

The prices below are invented for practice. On your zakāh date, use the real price of gold or silver per gram in your market.

Example 1. Aishah has ₦1,800,000 in her bank, ₦200,000 cash at home, and gold earrings she wears. Her zakāh date is 1 Ramaḍān, and her money has been above the niṣāb all year. The niṣāb her teacher uses is the silver one, worth ₦1,000,000 in this example.

→ Her wearing jewellery is not zakatable in the school.

→ Money: ₦1,800,000 + ₦200,000 = ₦2,000,000, above the niṣāb.

→ Zakāh = ₦2,000,000 × 2.5% = ₦2,000,000 ÷ 40.

Zakāh: ₦50,000

Example 2. Ibrahim runs a provisions shop. On his zakāh date: stock worth ₦3,600,000 at wholesale price, cash ₦400,000, customers owe him ₦500,000 that he expects to receive, and he owes a supplier ₦1,000,000.

→ He is a continuous trader (mudīr): value stock, add cash and good debts, subtract what he owes.

→ ₦3,600,000 + ₦400,000 + ₦500,000 − ₦1,000,000 = ₦3,500,000.

→ Zakāh = ₦3,500,000 ÷ 40.

Zakāh: ₦87,500

Example 3. Musa harvests 1,200 kg of dried maize from a rain-fed farm.

→ Maize is a staple that is stored: zakatable. 1,200 kg is above the niṣāb of about 650 kg.

→ Rain-fed: 10%.

Zakāh: 120 kg of maize

Example 4. Fatimah owns 135 goats, kept for a full year, and 25 cows.

→ Goats: 121–200 = 2 goats.

→ Cows: below 30, nothing.

Zakāh: 2 goats

Example 5. Yusuf lent his friend ₦800,000 three years ago and received it back this month.

→ A loan given: zakāh is paid once, for one year, when received (if it reaches the niṣāb alone or with his other money).

→ ₦800,000 ÷ 40.

Zakāh: ₦20,000, once

Worksheet My zakāh worksheet

Fill this in on your zakāh date each year. Keep it with your records.

	Item	Amount (₦)
1	My zakāh date this year (Hijrī)	
2	Price of 1 g of gold / silver today	
3	Niṣāb (85 g gold or 595 g silver × line 2)	
4	Cash at home	
5	Bank accounts, savings, mobile wallets	
6	Gold and silver not for wearing (value)	
7	Business stock at wholesale value (continuous trader)	
8	Money owed to my business that I expect to receive	
9	Total (4 + 5 + 6 + 7 + 8)	
10	Debts I must pay now (if no other property covers them)	
11	Zakatable wealth (9 − 10). Is it at least line 3?	
12	Zakāh due: line 11 ÷ 40	
13	Paid to (and date)	

Crops, livestock and loans repaid are calculated separately, as in Parts 4 to 6.

Test Self-test

Choose the best answer. The answers follow the questions.

1. Zakāh is which pillar of Islām?

a) The first b) The second c) The third d) The fifth

2. The niṣāb of gold is about:

a) 20 g b) 85 g c) 200 g d) 595 g

3. The rate of zakāh on money is:

a) 1% b) 10% c) 2.5% d) 20%

4. In the Mālikī school, a woman's jewellery that she wears:

a) Has no zakāh b) Pays 2.5% every year c) Pays 10% d) Pays once

5. A trader who holds land waiting for a good price pays zakāh:

a) Every year b) Never c) Each month d) Once, when he sells, for one year

6. Rain-fed maize above the niṣāb pays:

a) 2.5% b) 10% c) 5% d) Nothing

7. Is there zakāh on yams and cassava in the school?

a) Yes, 10% b) Yes, 2.5% c) No, unless traded d) Only in Ramaḍān

8. How many goats must you own before zakāh is due?

a) 5 b) 30 c) 100 d) 40

9. Which of these may receive your zakāh?

a) Your poor brother b) Your mother c) Your wife d) Your young son

10. A loan you gave years ago is repaid. Its zakāh is paid:

a) Once, for one year b) For every year it was owed c) Never d) By the borrower

11. Who collects zakāh may be paid from it:

a) Only if poor b) Even if rich c) Never d) Only in Ramaḍān

12. The lunar year for zakāh is about:

a) 365 days b) 300 days c) 354 days d) 400 days

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	c) The third	7	c) No, unless traded
2	b) 85 g	8	d) 40
3	c) 2.5%	9	a) Your poor brother
4	a) No zakāh	10	a) Once, for one year
5	d) Once, when he sells	11	b) Even if rich
6	b) 10%	12	c) 354 days

For further study

- **Ar-Risālah** of Ibn Abī Zayd al-Qayrawānī, the chapter on zakāh.
- **Al-Muwaṭṭaʾ** of Imām Mālik, the Book of Zakāh.
- **Al-Murshid al-Muʿīn** of Ibn ʿĀshir with its commentary, the section on zakāh.

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The right of the poor, the purity of your wealth.

This free guide from the Himaayah Madrasah explains zakāh according to the school of Imām Mālik, clearly and with the evidence, so you can calculate and pay it with confidence.

- The conditions, the year and the niṣāb of each kind of wealth
- Cash, savings, jewellery and debts
- Business stock, crops and livestock tables
- The eight categories of recipients
- Worked examples in naira and a yearly worksheet

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